

Chapter 85-2 - Escape

After a long while, the Emperor finally spoke, his voice deep and resonant: "You can't even watch over a small cultivator - what use are you to me? Investigate thoroughly who let her escape! All immortal soldiers on duty today shall have their immortal veins severed and be expelled from Penglai."

The others all lowered their heads, not daring to speak.

"Lord Wen Yao¹, lead the Black Scales² out of Penglai again. You must capture that demon creature. If she truly resists stubbornly, kill her on the spot and bring her corpse to me!"

Lord Wen Yao stepped forward from among the group, bowing his head: "Yes, Emperor."

With that, he hurriedly departed. The others also dared not linger and all took their leave. Thus only the Emperor remained in the hall, lowering his head to stare at the unfinished handkerchief, murderous intent rising in his eyes.

"Ning Fuyi, now that foolish woman is finally dead. Without her protection, let's see how long you can hide."

He smiled coldly as he spoke to himself.

Meanwhile, Ning Fuyi and the others had already followed Xiangliu and burst out of Penglai Realm. Xiangliu was after all an ancient fierce beast, incomparably faster than those immortal soldiers and generals. Soon they were soaring and diving through the clouds.

Endless clouds drifted past their ankles. The nine-headed Xiangliu stretched its nine mouths in all directions, swallowing birds flying through the sky.

Jiuying was still laughing. She laughed until she coughed up several mouthfuls of blood, then covered her heart and panted: "I haven't been this happy in so many years! If I weren't severely injured, I'd really want to circle Penglai a few more times and burn all of Penglai to the ground - that would live up to my reputation as a 'demon beast'!"

"Hey, little girl, we're out now. You can lift your head," Jiuying patted Baili Shiqi, who had been curled up trembling on Xiangliu's tail. "Thank you for your help just now. Do you want some qilin scales? I'm willing to give you some as repayment."

She reached to touch her own body, then her beautiful face showed embarrassment: "Aiya, they plucked almost all of them off."

Baili Shiqi suddenly raised her head, looking at the clouds drifting beneath her feet, then covered her face and sobbed: "It's over, it's over! I actually treated my own kind like this - I'm a sinner for the ages!"

"Those people in Penglai, except for you, all lack brains. Don't worry, since you saved us this time, we definitely won't abandon you. Once I recover from my injuries, if that Emperor whatever comes to catch you, I'll swallow him in one gulp!" Jiuying said.

Hearing this, Baili Shiqi quickly waved her hands: "No, no, no! Emperor Tianrui³ has True God level cultivation - there are few in the world who can surpass him. You mustn't fall into his hands again. Besides..."

"Besides, Penglai must have misunderstood, which is why they treated Sister Ning as a demon. When I go back and explain properly to them, surely..."

"You silly girl are really naive. Still explaining? When they see you, they'll kill you along with us!" Jiuying rolled her golden eyes.

Baili Shiqi lowered her head and hooked her fingers, saying softly: "Sisters, don't worry. I, Baili Shiqi, am not a fool. Since I dared to let you go, I definitely won't be implicated."

With that, she looked up and grinned.

Jiuying looked at her apple-like face, her mouth moved, but in the end she didn't say anything hurtful. She covered her heart and turned to Ning Fuyi, who had been silently watching the sea of clouds, her voice rarely gentle: "Hey, what do you plan to do now?"

"You definitely can't return to Cloud Ascension Mountain Gate. I heard those immortal soldiers say that now all four realms listen to Penglai. If you appear, you'll definitely be hunted down."

"Sigh, just found a place to shelter, and now I, Qi Jiuying, am homeless again." Jiuying rested her head on her knees. "Tell me, where can we go?"

Ning Fuyi touched the thought bead, withdrew her gaze and the red in her eyes, her voice flat: "If the four realms won't tolerate us, aren't there still two realms left?"

"The God Realm is gone - you mean the Demon Realm?" Jiuying's narrow eyes widened completely. "Don't joke around. The Demon Realm is full of war and chaos, like a living hell. You're not even a demon now - if you go in, they'll surely skin you alive."

"Besides, everyone says the demon clan is secretive. How would you know the entrance?"

"Mm, what a coincidence - I happen to know," Ning Fuyi looked back at her, a trace of light appearing in her withered eyes.

"But before that, I want to make a trip to the Jiang family⁴ at Wushan⁵ first. There are some things I need to ask Jiang Li⁶."

Ning Fuyi reached into the thought bead, her fingertip gently touching the seed that had already sprouted.

The moment the small sprout touched her finger, it suddenly shyly curled up its leaves and shrank back into the soil.

"To ask about Chu Qingqiu," she said softly.

Footnotes:

1. **Lord Wen Yao (文曜君):** A high-ranking official in Penglai Realm, responsible for military operations
2. **Black Scales (黑鳞):** An elite military unit in Penglai, likely named for their black-scaled armor
3. **Emperor Tianrui (天瑞帝君):** "Heavenly Auspicious Emperor" - the supreme ruler of Penglai Realm
4. **Jiang family (江家):** The family clan of Jiang Li, a prominent medical family
5. **Wushan (巫山):** "Witch Mountain" - the location where the Jiang family resides
6. **Jiang Li (江离):** A medical immortal who was Chu Qingqiu's friend and previously treated Ning Fuyi